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February 5, 2026

Review Committee
UCLA Distinguished Teaching Award

Subject: Nomination Letter for Distinguished Teaching Award for Ms. Gloria Hyun

Dear Review Committee Members:

This is a nomination letter for **Distinguished Teaching Award for Ms. Gloria Hyun**.

Gloria is a 3rd-year PhD student at the Department of Civil and Environmental Engineering at UCLA. I am also Gloria's research advisor on her PhD thesis entitled *Seismic Risk Analyis of Natural Gas Transmission Network*. Gloria has also been Teaching Assistant (TA) in my graduate course CEE245 on *Earthquake Ground Motion Characterization*. This course covers multiple aspects of earthquake ground motions and is one of the most popular graduate courses in the Department. Students on this course have diverse backgrounds from Structural Engineering, Geotechnical Engineering and occasionally from Geology. Therefore, the role of the TA in this course is more challenging than other courses as the TA has to have focused office hours and discussion sessions and elaborate the course materials for students with different background. Gloria did an excellent job as the TA of the course in Winter quarter of 2025. She prepared a set of instructions for the students to run a new computer program to compute response spectra, and the students could successfully carry out the computations. Gloria's professional and mentoring style made the students comfortable asking their questions. She also made herself available for some students who could not attend her regular office hours. She also attended all lectures even though she knew the course contents.

Gloria received her BS agree from MIT and MS degree from the CEE Department at UCLA. She worked for four years as a practicing engineer in private industry before coming back to UCLA for her PhD degree. Her professional experience has been very much helpful to effectively communicate with students and give them real-world examples.

I strongly and enthusiastically nominate Gloria for the **Distinguished Teaching Award.** We need to appreciate high-performance graduate students like Gloria. If you have any question or need more information, please do not hesitate to contact me at: yousef.bozorgnia@ucla.edu.

Sincerely,



Yousef Bozorgnia, Ph.D., P.E., F.ASCE
Professor, Department of Civil and Environmental Engineering,
Past and Founding Director, Natural Hazards Risk and Resileincy Research Center (NHR3)
University of California, Los Angeles (UCLA)

Gloria Hyun
Nominee Statement

I have served as a Teaching Assistant for two courses in the Civil and Environmental Engineering department: CEE 190 (Professional Practice) and CEE 245 (Earthquake Ground Motion Characterization). My teaching focused on identifying barriers to student learning and implementing personalized and practical guidance to help students while also reinforcing the standards expected of professional engineers.

In CEE 190, the course addressed engineering ethics, professional misconduct, and licensure. While the instructor led in-depth ethics related materials during class drawing on his 30+ years of experience as a geotechnical engineer, I was responsible for the practical engineering materials required for the California-specific Professional Engineer licensure exam, which falls under my area of expertise. Discussions were on the design of structures under influences of lateral forces, specifically earthquake and wind. A key challenge was that students came from all civil engineering subdisciplines—geotechnical, materials, water, environmental, transportation—not solely structural engineering, hence many had limited prior exposure to lateral design concepts. To address this, I did not dive straight into equations. Instead, as shown in Teaching Artifact 1, I applied a car passenger example—something everyone can relate to—and expanded it to buildings during earthquakes. I then stated clear goals, provided step-by-step methods for achieving them, and offered accessible explanations of concepts and code language that non-structural students would be unfamiliar with. Detailed calculations were conducted only after these steps were established. This approach allowed students with diverse backgrounds to follow the material while maintaining alignment with professional and exam expectations.

In CEE 245, a graduate-level course, students came from structural, geotechnical, and geology backgrounds, each bringing different foundational knowledge. All students faced the same barrier: navigating numerous analytical tools required throughout the course and choosing appropriate methods for various applications. To address this, I established discussion sessions on tool application. The RCTC session was a 3-hour hands-on workshop where I worked one-on-one with each student to install and configure the RCTC tool (an R program for ground motion analysis), demonstrated its capabilities, and explained when to use different features for specific analyses, as shown in Teaching Artifact 2. With follow-up email support, students successfully applied these tools in homework. Similar sessions were held for each new tool introduced in class. One geotechnical student working part-time reported that a session directly benefited his professional work, as he now regularly uses one of the spreadsheets we covered.

For all courses I served as a Teaching Assistant, I attended all class sessions in person to increase accessibility and closely follow course emphasis. This consistent presence had three benefits: first, it allowed students to approach me before and after class for informal clarification; second, it enabled conversations beyond homework, where I drew from my experience as a licensed Professional Engineer in California to discuss careers and professional transition; and third, observing the professor in real time enabled me to identify confusing topics and tailor discussion sections to reinforce key concepts and clarify misunderstandings.

I provided individualized feedback through email and flexible office hours to accommodate different schedules. Several students proactively shared homework with me prior to deadlines, seeking clarification on lateral design (see Teaching Artifact 1). I reviewed their work in detail, identifying mistakes and explaining why errors occurred rather than providing answers, allowing students to correct

themselves. Through this iterative process—sometimes repeated several times—these students demonstrated strong mastery and earned perfect scores on homework and quizzes.

I also encouraged students to meet with me after quiz and homework solutions were posted to review mistakes. I conducted these sessions during scheduled office hours and at flexible times I arranged to accommodate schedules, often meeting individually for 30+ minutes. In CEE 245, approximately 7 of 30 students visited multiple times throughout the term. We reconstructed their thought process step-by-step, identifying where mistakes occurred, and I shared strategies to recognize and avoid similar errors. Students who regularly attended these sessions showed marked improvement, outperforming their midterm scores on the final exam.

My teaching reflects evidence-based practices: identifying learning barriers, adapting instruction to diverse student backgrounds, providing formative feedback, and implementing targeted strategies to support student success. I have drawn on my experience as a practicing structural engineer to refine my teaching, with the goal of preparing students for both professional licensure and responsible engineering practice.

Gloria Hyun

Statement of Teaching Philosophy

In short, I believe that students learn best when they "get their hands dirty." My teaching philosophy is grounded in the belief that meaningful learning occurs through sustained effort, deliberate practice, and personal responsibility. Understanding cannot be passively received; it must be constructed through repeated engagement with problems, mistakes, and reflections. I consider the role of a teaching assistant as one who, rather than eliminating difficulties, provides a learning environment where productive struggle leads to long-lasting understanding and professional growth. Mastery requires going through the cycle of solving problems, revisiting mistakes, and reworking incorrect solutions until the reasoning becomes second nature. This process mirrors professional engineering practice, where intuition is developed through repetition and iteration.

I emphasize clear reasoning backed by conceptual understanding, practice, and revision over answer-driven learning, which was a belief shaped in part by my undergraduate education at MIT. Direct answers were rarely handed out, and students were expected to wrestle with problem sets for days, identify holes in their understanding, connect the dots, and resolve them independently or through collaboration with classmates. While demanding, this approach cultivated resilience and intellectual ownership—skills that proved immensely helpful to me in both graduate study and professional practice. I implement a similar philosophy in my teaching by providing guidance and structure without prematurely resolving hardship for students.

I often think of learning as analogous to cultivating a grapevine. The strongest vines with sweetest grapes are not grown by watering the soil directly at their roots, but by watering just beyond immediate reach. In response, the roots extend outward, growing deeper and stronger to access what they need. Likewise, effective teaching places support close enough to be attainable, yet far enough to require effort. This approach honors students' capacity for rigorous thinking.

For this reason, I encourage students to attempt to solve the problems on their own before seeking help, as this prior struggle makes our discussions more productive, their learning more permanent, thus building the autonomy essential for professional engineers. This approach is not intended to withhold help, but to ensure that instruction builds on active engagement rather than spoon-feeding. Once students have articulated their own lines of reasoning, feedback becomes meaningful, misconceptions can be spotted and corrected efficiently, and learning outcomes improve substantially.

Underlying all these practices is my belief that the goal of engineering education is the development of sound engineering intuition. This intuition cannot be memorized or shortcut; it is cultivated through rigorous training, repeated exposure to complex problems, and disciplined reasoning grounded in first principles. Developing such judgment is, in my view, a professional obligation, not merely an academic outcome, as our work bears real consequences for public safety. Ethics and professional responsibility are therefore inseparable from technical training.

The classical texts I grew up reading, such as *Admonitions on Governing the People*, *Precious Mirror for Enlightening the Mind*, and *Aesop's Fables*, all emphasize integrity, accountability, and the consequences of one's actions on others. These early ideas shaped my understanding of ethics as a practical responsibility of a member of society, rather than merely an abstract concept. This perspective was later reinforced through formal engineering training and the profession's emphasis on licensure, codes of ethics, and the primacy of public safety, where decisions are rarely abstract, and errors—both technical and ethical—can have tangible consequences for the public.

However, during my time in the industry, I was struck by how frequently ethical lapses arise in engineering, not necessarily through overt misconduct, but in many shapes and forms such as incomplete designs, poor judgment, disregard for protocols, or misrepresentation, sometimes by omission. These experiences reinforced my conviction that rigorous technical preparation must be paired with equally rigorous ethical standards. As a result, I distinguish clearly between academic struggle and ethical conduct. I am deeply committed to helping students who put forth effort, regardless of their initial level of understanding, since confusion and mistakes are expected and supported. Dishonesty and misrepresentation are not. I hold firm expectations regarding professionalism and integrity, reflecting the standards required of engineers whose work directly affects the public.

Ultimately, my teaching philosophy is rooted in respect—for the discipline, for the profession, and for students' capacity to meet high expectations. By combining principled standards, purposeful challenge, and responsive support, I aim to prepare students beyond academic success, to help them develop intuition, integrity, and responsibility as professional engineers.

Description:

The following screenshots are excerpts from the slides prepared for a discussion session on seismic design. Slides include the philosophy behind seismic design, step-by-step methods, guidance on navigating design codes, and a comprehensive example problem at the end. The slides were carefully designed with students from non-structural engineering subdisciplines in mind, with extra effort to make complex concepts and jargons easy to understand. Similar slides were created for wind design.

Supporting student feedback:

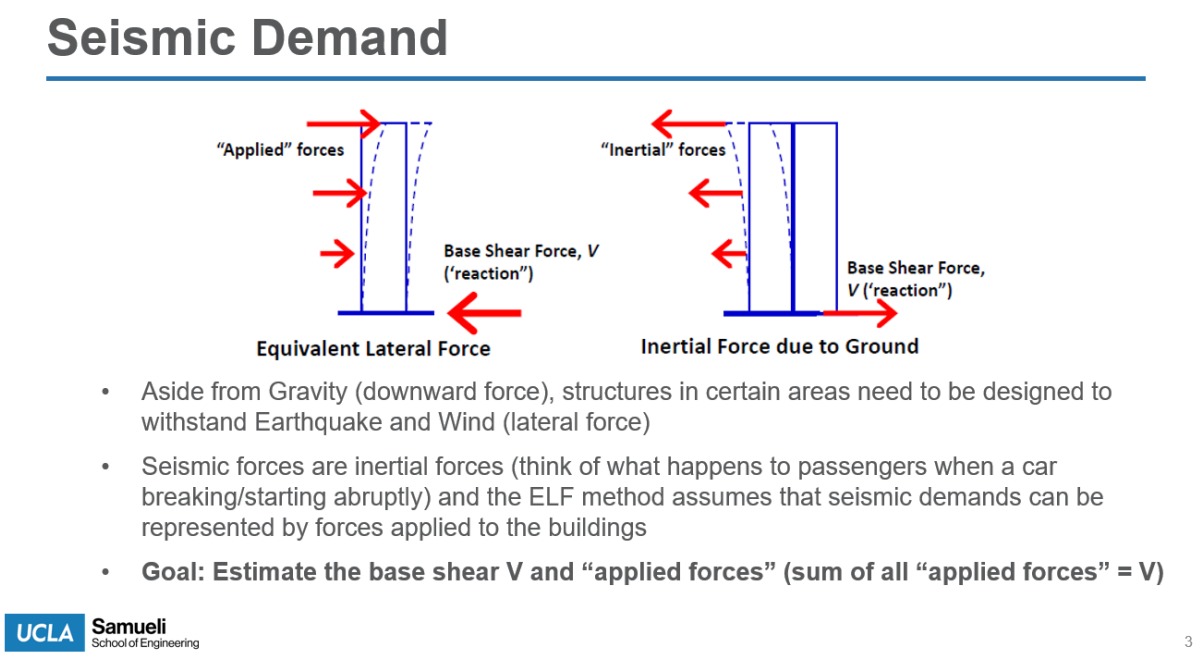
> Gloria was an excellent TA. She consistently reviewed the lecture material clearly and helped reinforce key concepts in a way that made them easier to understand. She was always willing to help with homework questions and provided thoughtful guidance whenever I needed it. I also appreciated how approachable and supportive she was. She created an environment where I felt comfortable asking anything, whether it was about the course or general academic advice.

> There was a lot of helpful information provided in the discussion slides, and Gloria also communicated a lot through bruin learn which was nice. Thank you for the effort you put into our discussions!

> The TA did a wonderful job of reviewing course materials and working through applicable examples during discussions. There are no weaknesses of note.

> The slides and notes from discussion we're easy to follow and understand. It helped me prepare for the quizzes and homework. Gloria is very kind and knowledgeable.

Slide excerpts from a seismic design discussion:



Screenshot 1. Introductory slide from seismic design discussion. I begin with car passenger example to remind students of the lurching feelings that occur when a car abruptly starts/stops, and explain that is exactly what the buildings feel when earthquake hits them. End goal is stated to set a clear expectation of what students should walk away with after the discussion session.

Estimating Seismic Demands

1. METHOD OF ANALYSIS
2. SITE COEFFICIENTS
3. SEISMIC DESIGN CATEGORY
4. SEISMIC BASE SHEAR
5. SEISMIC FORCES
6. STORY DRIFT
7. LOAD COMBINATION

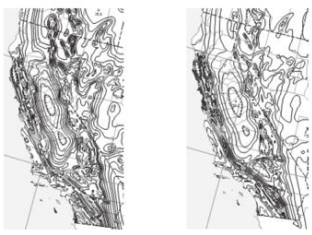
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Screenshot 2. Step-by-step layout of seismic design to reach the end goal stated in the introductory slide from Screenshot 1.

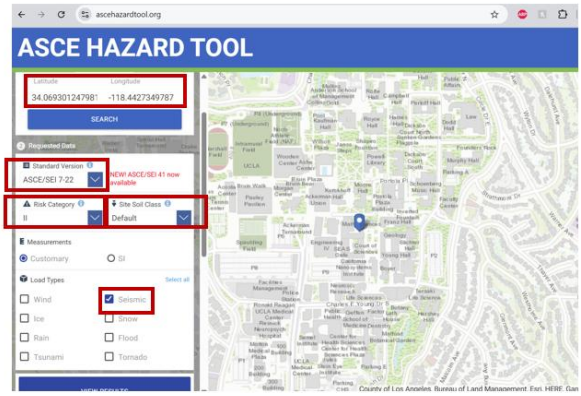
Estimating Seismic Demands cont.

2. SITE COEFFICIENTS

- Back in the days: Look parameters in maps in figures, flip through several chapters, tables, etc.
- Now, simply input a few information to ATC by Hazard (https://ascehazardtool.org/)



S_S and S_1 spectral ordinate
[Fig 22-1, 22-2]



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Screenshot 3. I drew from my experience as a structural design engineer to explain the tools used in industry to design structures. Before, engineers had to refer to a map shown on left and hand-calculate every parameter required for seismic load demand. Now, simply inputting a few information generates all necessary parameters. I relayed what I learned from my experience and emphasized the importance

of not relying on technology to build engineering intuition. I encouraged students to go through the hand calculation to verify whether their answers match that of the tool, and a few groups reached out through email asking about the discrepancies in their hand calculated parameters from the tool generated parameters, and I was able to help them close the gaps through indirect guidance.

Estimating Seismic Demands cont.

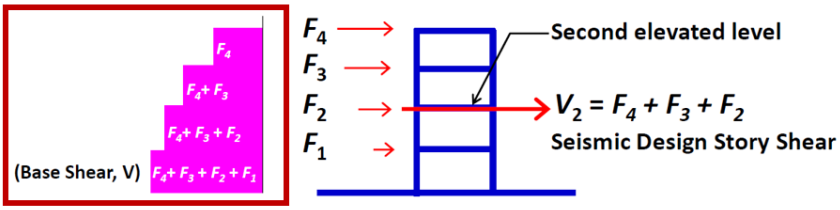
5. SEISMIC FORCES CONT.

- Story Shear (V_X)

12.8.4 Horizontal Distribution of Forces. The seismic design story shear in any story (V_x) [kip (kN)] shall be determined from the following equation:

$$V_x = \sum_{i=x}^{n} F_i \qquad (12.8\text{-}13)$$

where F_i = the portion of the seismic base shear (V) [kip (kN)] induced at level i.



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Screenshot 4. An example of a step from Screenshot 2. Texts are an excerpt from a building design load code. Realizing that not all students are familiar with the notations in building design load code, I explain what each notation (*V*, *F*, n) means and created figures to illustrate what Eq. (12.8-13) summarizes.

A 7-story office building located at 11075 Santa Monica Blvd, Los Angeles, CA, building uses special reinforced concrete shear walls for the SFRS. The plan dimensions of the building are 150 ft. by 200 ft. The typical floor-to-floor height is 14.5 ft. A parapet extends the exterior wall above the roof by 4 ft.

The floors weigh 75 psf, not including a 10 psf partition allowance required by ASCE 7 for seismic calculations. Note that it is assumed that the roof and ground floor brace half the partition load supported by a typical floor. The roof weighs 65 psf plus 50 K of mechanical equipment.

The exterior wall weighs 15 psf. Note that it is assumed that floors support half the wall weight below the floor and half the wall weight above the floor. Similarly, the roof supports half the wall weight below the roof and the parapet above the roof.

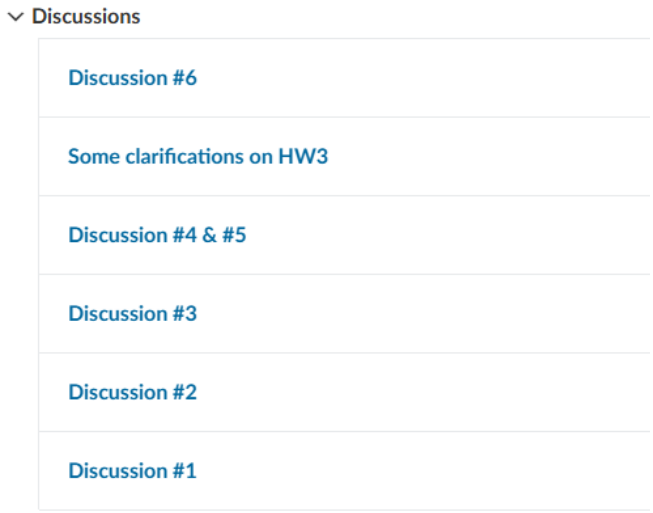
A dynamic analysis of the building calculated a fundamental period of 1.01 sec. The Site Class is C.

1. Obtain the seismic coefficients for the site (i.e., S_S, S_1, F_a, F_v, etc.)
2. Calculate the effective seismic weight of the building.
3. Calculate the governing building period.
4. Calculate the governing seismic coefficient, C_s.
5. Calculate the base shear, V.
6. Calculate the vertical distribution of the story forces and the resulting story shears. Plot the results on an elevation of the building.

Screenshot 5. An example problem was given towards the end of the seismic design discussion. This helped me identify the part students struggled with the most. Using the information, I made edits (noted in light blue texts as shown on 7. LOAD COMBINATION of Screenshot 1 and the title of the slide from Screenshot 4) to the slides after the discussion session to further clarify any confusion before sharing it with the students as shown below.

Interaction through Bruinlearn:

All materials I prepared for students were shared. Any edits to help enhance understanding were made and shared in timely manner.



Description:

The following screenshots are excerpts from the slides prepared for a discussion session on utilizing various tools. Slides include the introduction of several tools, explanation of concepts behind them, and proper utilization of said tools. The slides were carefully designed with students from diverse subdisciplines in mind, with extra effort to make complex concepts and jargon easy to understand.

Supporting student feedback:

- TA was very helpful; she provided extra office hours if students were struggling and always made sure that we understood the material.
- I never attended a discussion section, so I have little to say about how Gloria managed those. I did go to her for office hours though, and I appreciated her willingness to help me. She often made herself available outside the set office hours, and I felt like I understood the assignments better after speaking to her.
- Gloria is very nice and is willing to help. It seems she also is willing to answer emails and is overall decently accommodating.
- During the discussions, it was sometimes difficult to follow and understand what needed to be done with the softwares. We had to install many different programs, and it was sometimes a hassle, especially with "R." During one of these sessions, the issue with my computer wasn't resolved after 1.5 hours of trying. Otherwise, she answered our questions well, so it was still good.

Slide excerpts from a seismic design discussion:

General Process

- Need to create Ground Motion Models (GMMs)
  - Data Collection
    - ex. 100 ground motion samples collected
  - Data Processing
    - ex. PGA of each GM
  - Data Analysis – Median and Beta values obtained
    - ex. How many GMs have PGAs ranging from 0.1g to 0.15g; How many GMs with M = 6 have PGAs above 0.3g
- Luckily, there are GMMs created by someone else we can use
  - Use given Median and Beta values for now
  - Note that Median is $\bar{m}$ of Y and Beta is σ of $\ln_{(Y)}$

Screenshot 1. Introductory slide on ground motion models. Ground motion models rely heavily on statistical concepts such as lognormal and binomial distribution. This discussion was organized for Week 1 so that students with different backgrounds could all have the same starting ground.

Combining Lognormal and Binomial Distributions

Example application of Binomial and Lognormal distributions

- Again: p = P(a GM with IM=x causes collapse)
  - ➔ p= P(collapse| IM=x)
    - = by definition is a "Fragility function"
    - = very commonly is assumed to be a Lognormal cumulative density function, with median value of θ and standard deviation of $\beta_{ln(IM)}$

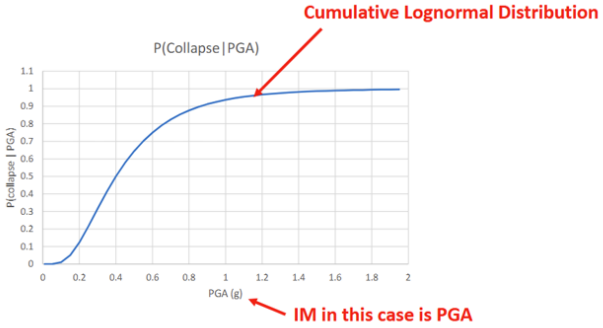
Example application of Binomial and Lognormal distributions

- Again: *p* = P(a GM with *IM=x* causes collapse)
  - ➔ *p*= P(collapse| IM=x)
    - = Cumulative Lognormal distribution with
      Median = ln(θ) and
      Standard deviation = $\beta_{ln(IM)}$
    - = $\Phi\left(\frac{\ln(x)-\ln(\theta)}{\beta}\right)$
  - ➔ $P(z \text{ GMs cause collpase out of total of n GMs}) = \frac{n!}{z!(n-z)!}p^z(1-p)^{(n-z)}$

Combining Lognormal and Binomial Distributions cont'd

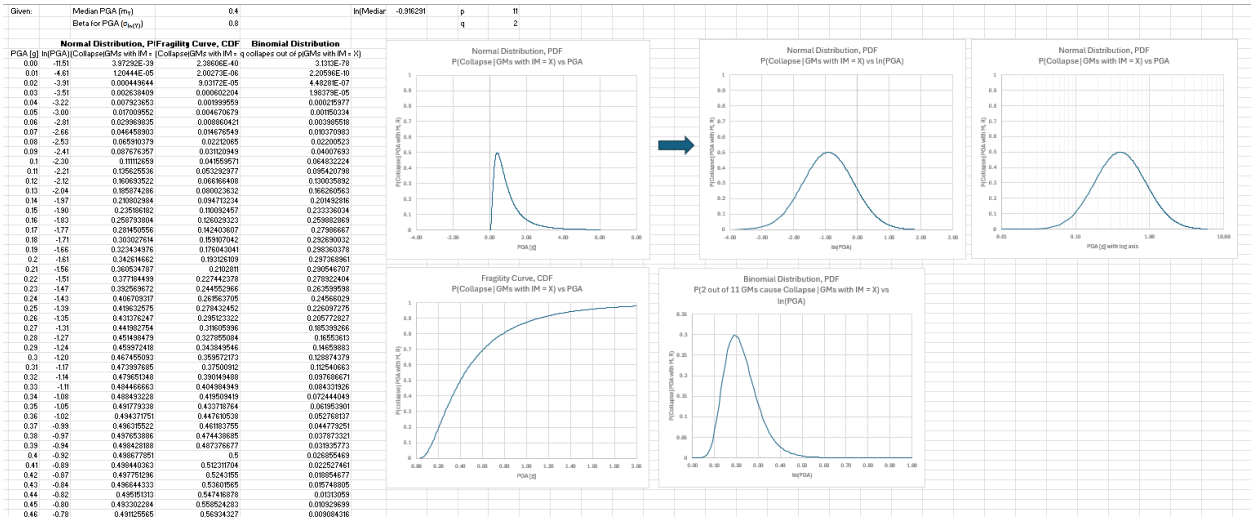
Hypothetical example of a fragility function

- Median = 0.4g
- β = 0.6



- At PGA=0.4g, n=11 GMs, z=2 GMs
  - ➔P(2 GMs out of 11 GMs cause collapse) = 2.7%

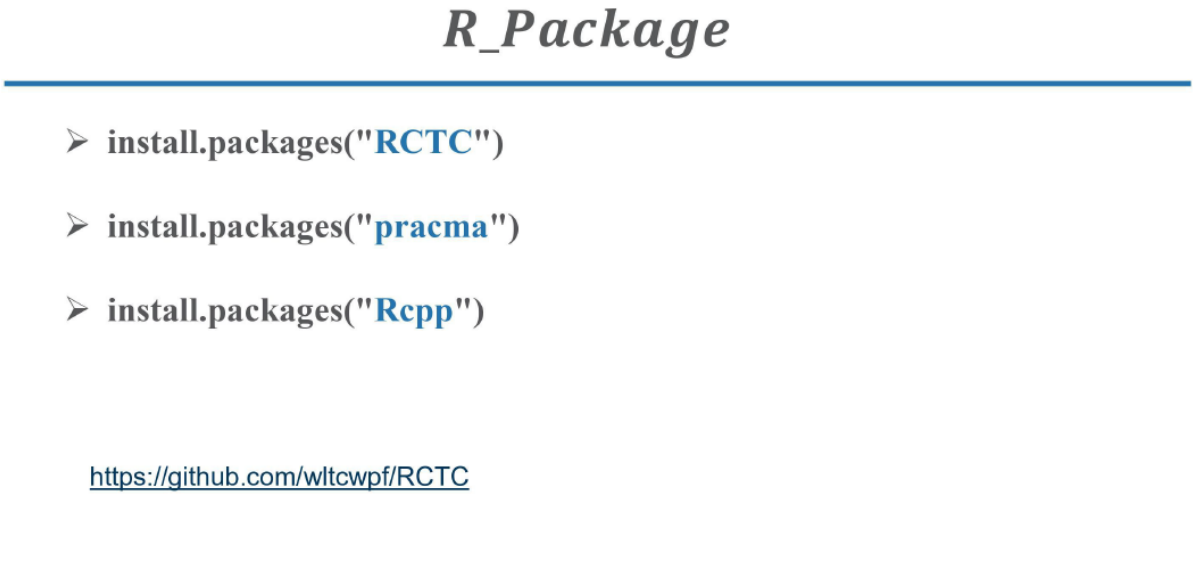
Screenshot 2. During the Week 1 discussion, I briefly reiterated the combining of lognormal and binomial distribution as was explained by the professor during class in preparation of introduction of excel tool shown in Screenshot 3.



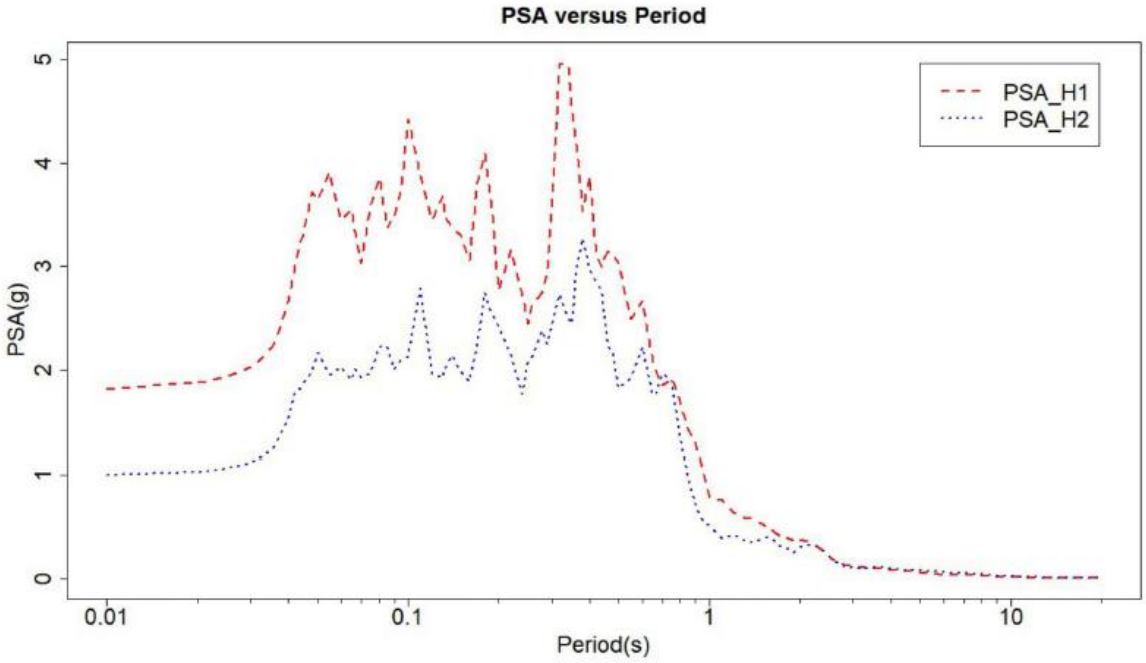
Given:		Median PGA (m_1)	0.4		ln(Median	-0.916291	p	11
		Beta for PGA ($\sigma_{ln(Y)}$)	0.8				q	2

	Normal Distribution, PI	Fragility Curve, CDF	Binomial Distribution
PGA [g]	ln(PGA)	P(Collapse|GMs with IM = x)	P(Collapse|GMs with IM = x)	collapsed out of p|GMs with IM = X)
0.00	-11.51	3.97292E-39	2.38608E-40	3.1313E-78
0.01	-4.61	1.20444E-05	2.00272E-06	2.20596E-10
0.02	-3.91	0.000439644	9.03772E-05	4.49289E-07
0.03	-3.51	0.002638409	0.000602204	1.98379E-05
0.04	-3.22	0.007923653	0.001999559	0.000215977
0.05	-3.00	0.01709952	0.004676679	0.001150334
0.06	-2.81	0.029963935	0.008860421	0.003985518
0.07	-2.66	0.046458903	0.014678549	0.010370983
0.08	-2.53	0.065910379	0.02212065	0.02200523
0.09	-2.41	0.087676357	0.031020949	0.04007693
0.1	-2.30	0.11112659	0.041559571	0.064832224
0.11	-2.21	0.135625536	0.053232977	0.095420798
0.12	-2.12	0.160833522	0.066166408	0.130035892
0.13	-2.04	0.185874286	0.080023632	0.166260563
0.14	-1.97	0.210802984	0.094713234	0.20492816
0.15	-1.90	0.235186182	0.110092457	0.233336034
0.16	-1.83	0.258793804	0.126029323	0.259882369
0.17	-1.77	0.281450556	0.142403607	0.27986667
0.18	-1.71	0.303027614	0.159107042	0.292690032
0.19	-1.66	0.323434976	0.176043041	0.298360378
0.2	-1.61	0.342614662	0.19312609	0.297368961
0.21	-1.56	0.360534787	0.210281	0.290546707
0.22	-1.51	0.377184439	0.227442378	0.278922404
0.23	-1.47	0.392569672	0.244552966	0.263599598
0.24	-1.43	0.406709317	0.261563705	0.24566029
0.25	-1.39	0.419632575	0.278432452	0.226097275
0.26	-1.35	0.431376247	0.29512322	0.205772827
0.27	-1.31	0.441982754	0.31160596	0.185399266
0.28	-1.27	0.45149479	0.327855094	0.16553613
0.29	-1.24	0.459972418	0.343849546	0.14659883
0.3	-1.20	0.467455093	0.359572173	0.128874379
0.31	-1.17	0.473997695	0.37500912	0.112540663
0.32	-1.14	0.479651049	0.390149488	0.097698671
0.33	-1.11	0.484466663	0.404984949	0.084331926
0.34	-1.08	0.488493228	0.419509419	0.072444049
0.35	-1.05	0.491779338	0.433718764	0.061952901
0.36	-1.02	0.494371751	0.447593538	0.052768137
0.37	-0.99	0.496315522	0.46118375	0.044778251
0.38	-0.97	0.497653886	0.474438685	0.037873321
0.39	-0.94	0.498428888	0.487378677	0.031957773
0.4	-0.92	0.498677851	0.5	0.026855469
0.41	-0.89	0.498440063	0.512311704	0.022527461
0.42	-0.87	0.497751296	0.5241955	0.018854677
0.43	-0.84	0.496644333	0.53601565	0.015748805
0.44	-0.82	0.495151313	0.547416878	0.01313059
0.45	-0.80	0.493302284	0.558524283	0.010929699
0.46	-0.78	0.491125565	0.56934327	0.009084316

Screenshot 3. Practical tool for modeling combination of binomial and lognormal distribution was introduced for students to implement the concept described in Screenshot 2 for future ground motion modeling tools.



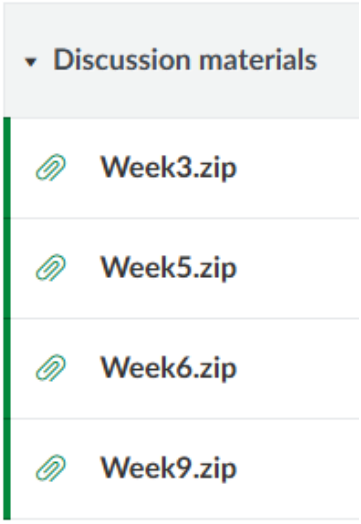
Screenshot 4. One of many installation instruction slides for a tool called “RCTC”. This is the R program that was mentioned in one of the Supporting student feedback. The discussion session extended over 3 hours, where I worked with everyone one on one to get the program installed and run on everyone’s laptop. Explanation of the tool’s applications followed.



Screenshot 5. An example of utilization of the tool shown in Screenshot 4. Students were shown various capabilities of the tool, and which ones to use for certain cases. Above example is an answer to one of many different plots students were asked to generate as part of the homework. After the 3-hour discussion session and lots of follow-up emails, students were successful in applying tools as needed.

Interaction through Bruinlearn:

All materials I prepared for students were shared. Any edits to help enhance understanding were made and shared in timely manner.



Distinguished Teaching Assistant — Letter of Recommendation

This award celebrates Teaching Assistants who demonstrate a pattern of effective teaching that incorporates current best practices (e.g., student-centered learning, active learning, inclusive teaching), aims to inspire and challenge students, and supports the success of all students.

Name Gloria Hyun

Briefly describe how you know the nominee. (50 words max)

Gloria was my Teaching Assistant for CEE 190 Professional Practice. I regularly attended her office hours, where she helped clarify course material, answered homework questions, and offered thoughtful advice about career paths in both industry and research.

In a few sentences, describe a few ways in which the nominee inspired or challenged you or other students in the class. (200 words max)

Gloria inspired me by openly sharing her experience working in industry before returning to pursue research. Hearing her talk about why she chose to come back to academia made research feel far more accessible and intentional, rather than something reserved for a narrow group of students. It showed me that engineering careers can evolve and that exploring different paths is not only acceptable but valuable.

She also challenged students through the way she interacted with us. Gloria spoke to me as an intellectual equal and never talked down to students, even when we asked basic or uncertain questions. That respect created an environment where I felt comfortable engaging deeply with the material. At the same time, it motivated me to push myself and not settle for surface-level understanding. Because she clearly believed students were capable, I felt challenged to meet that expectation and take my learning more seriously.

Describe one or two things that the nominee did that you thought were particularly beneficial for your (or other students') learning or understanding of concepts. (200 words max)

One of the most beneficial things Gloria did was frame analytical and statistical thinking in the context of professional engineering practice. When discussing how engineers take large amounts of information and distill it into a single, defensible conclusion, she emphasized how this process is used to justify decisions, communicate risk, and protect public safety in real projects. She helped us understand that in practice, it is not enough to arrive at an answer, engineers must be able to clearly explain their reasoning and stand behind it.

Gloria consistently tied these ideas to professional responsibility and PE licensure. Because she has gone through the licensure process herself, she was able to explain how becoming a licensed engineer allows one to take responsibility for work, contribute meaningfully to design decisions, and be recognized for that responsibility. She emphasized how important licensure is for accountability, ethical practice, and effective communication within engineering teams and with the public. By grounding technical thinking in licensure, ethics, and real professional expectations, she made the concepts feel practical, serious, and directly relevant to our future careers.

Please share any additional reasons why you believe the nominee is an outstanding candidate for this award. (100 words max)

Gloria is an outstanding candidate because she consistently put students first. She spent significant time during office hours supporting both academic understanding and professional growth, and she was always approachable, patient, and thoughtful. Her ability to connect coursework to real-world engineering practice, combined with her genuine care for student success, made a lasting impact on my learning experience. She exemplifies what effective and inclusive teaching should look like in engineering education.

Distinguished Teaching Assistant — Letter of Recommendation

This award celebrates Teaching Assistants who demonstrate a pattern of effective teaching that incorporates current best practices (e.g., student-centered learning, active learning, inclusive teaching), aims to inspire and challenge students, and supports the success of all students.

Name

Briefly describe how you know the nominee. (50 words max)

In a few sentences, describe a few ways in which the nominee inspired or challenged you or other students in the class. (200 words max)

Describe one or two things that the nominee did that you thought were particularly beneficial for your (or other students') learning or understanding of concepts. (200 words max)

Please share any additional reasons why you believe the nominee is an outstanding candidate for this award. (100 words max)

Memorandum

Date: February 10, 2026

From:



Martin B. Hudson, Ph.D., P.E., G.E.
Adjunct Professor

Subject **Recommendation for Ms. Gloria Hyun**
UCLA Teaching Assistant Distinguished Teaching Award

I am writing this letter of recommendation in support of Ms. Gloria Hyun' nomination for the Distinguished Teaching Award for her work as a Teaching Assistant at UCLA.

Ms. Hyun was the teaching assistant for the Professional Practice class (C&EE 190) for which I was the instructor at UCLA in the Civil and Environmental Engineering department. She was exceptionally self-driven to help the students in the class, grade the class material, and assist in the orchestration of the class. Her exceptionalism was most evident by her ability to answer questions of the students clearly and helpfully such that they were satisfied with her input. Ms. Hyun would be an excellent example of great teaching for other Teaching Assistants at UCLA, and I recommend her for the Distinguished Teaching award.

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